BEYOND THE SYLLABUS

Joelyn N. Pagaduan

March 04, 2026

The article presents a toxic workplace dynamic where a person in power, the Director of Instruction, repeatedly humiliates her subordinates in public. This situation creates a culture of fear and anxiety, where employees lose their motivation and simply try to avoid being criticized. The boss uses her authority to disrespect others, and this behavior is accepted as normal within the institution.

The key lesson is that respect must go both ways, especially between a leader and their employees. A person in power should not use humiliation to control others. The article teaches that if you stay silent and accept bad treatment, people will continue to treat you badly. Sometimes, you have to stand up for yourself to show that you deserve to be treated with dignity.

To rebuild respect, a person can set clear boundaries by calmly speaking up against the mistreatment, as the author did when she confronted her boss. Leaders can also help by changing their behavior, such as giving feedback in private instead of humiliating someone in front of others. Showing kindness and treating people with fairness can slowly rebuild a positive and respectful relationship.